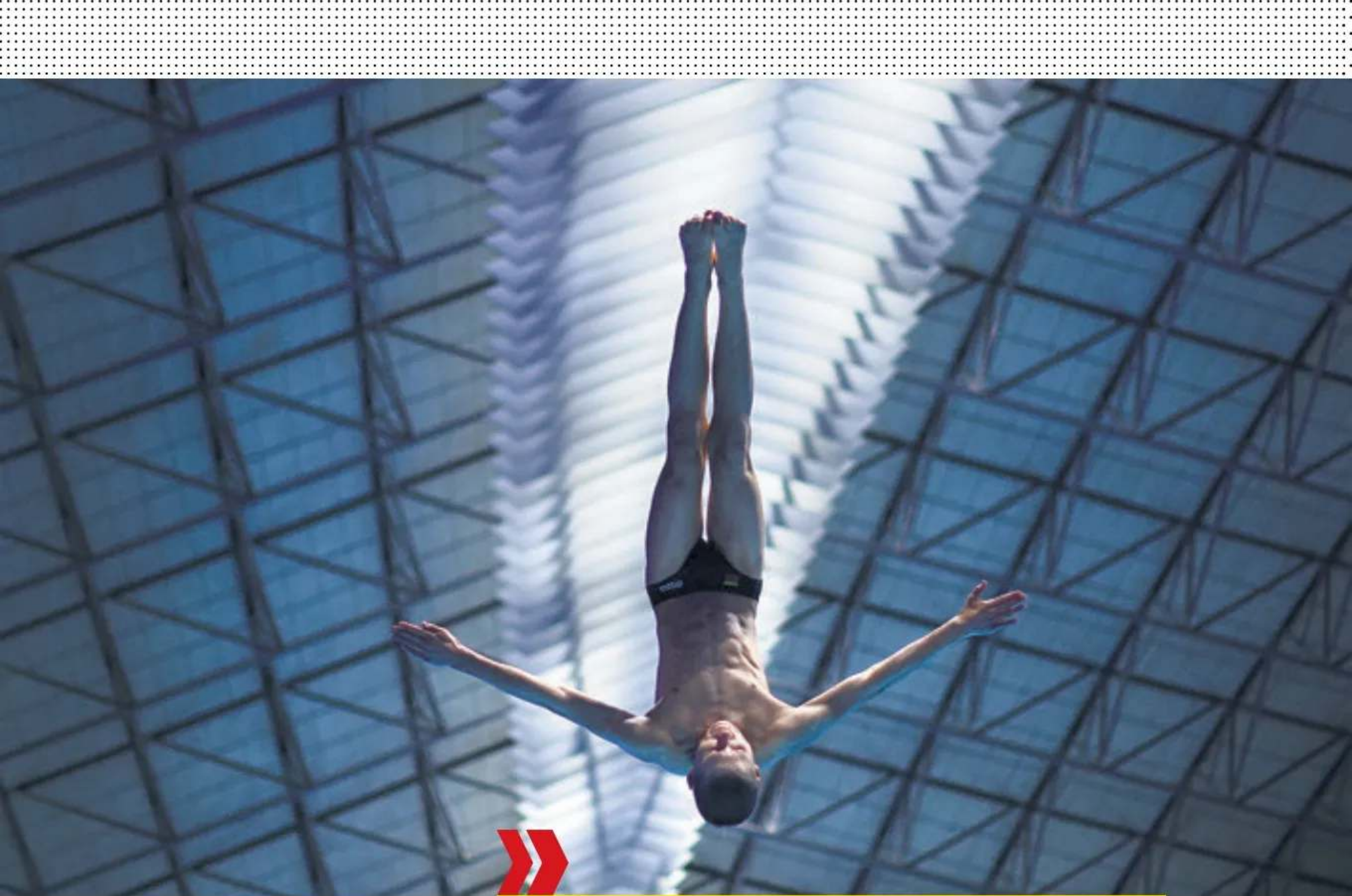




This is the way: It's important to establish individual profiling for each athlete. This establishes a genuine baseline for comparison based on their unique parameters. GETTY IMAGES

overlooks individual variability, failing to provide an accurate assessment.

— Utilising creatine kinase (CK) as a readiness measure is a good example of this concept. CK levels can be collected after matches from players who participated in most games. Additionally, variability assessment of individual athletes can be done based on their day-to-day physical activity, offering a reliable method for evaluation.

— The more data you collect, the easier it is to establish 'normal' values for individuals within the monitoring system.

Pragmatic applications

No single measure can tell you everything you want to know about an athlete; it's crucial to recognise this as a significant indicator. Many

RELYING ON TEAM AVERAGES OR GENERIC CUTOFF VALUES OVERLOOKS INDIVIDUAL VARIABILITY, FAILING TO PROVIDE ACCURATE ASSESSMENT OF AN ATHLETE'S READINESS

products on the market may claim to offer a one-stop solution with utmost accuracy for assessing an athlete's readiness, but it's all business spiel.

The best bet is to consider three to four variables and infer data from psychological and physiological parameters over a period of time to ensure accuracy. Combining subjective measures such as questionnaires with objective measures like HRV and strength index can provide correct knowledge of an athlete's readiness.

If two or more red flags appear in the variables, they should be studied further. Assessing an athlete's

readiness requires considering both subjective and objective factors, to obtain the most reliable data for taking calls about their next session.

The session can be modified according to the requirements of that particular training day, with the coach playing an important role in making the decisions. Be it the coach, physiotherapist, or strength and conditioning coach, debriefing with the player and support staff is essential. This ensures clarity and helps the athlete from being not confused and overwhelmed by complex data-crunching.

In the end, the coach has the final say in it!